

Thinnest bezel

LG has a display (not for consumer use) with a bezel that is 1.5mm thick, and 2mm at its maximum

Power consumption

Plasmas consume around three times more power than LCDs an average figure quoted was 301 watts VS 111 watts for LCDs

HDTV Test

to do without a couple of extra HDMI ports, or fewer options in the settings menu.

Build, ergonomics and features:

We got 4 TVs, three from Onida and one from Akai. The Akai looked nice with very solid plastics used, and a nice silver finish that has been made to look like wood grain with a lacquer coating.

Of the three Onidas, two were LCD, and had very solid plastics used, on account of which they were quite heavy. Onida has a very neat menu layout buttons are intuitively placed and colour coded.

While the Onida LCO32MMS had a large stand, the LCD32DRT has a smaller oval stand that feels too light for the TV and it doesn't swivel well. The Onida LEO32HMS was LED, like the Akai, and while the stand unit looked attractive, we couldn't figure how to fit it together securely.



Onida LCO32MMS

The glass base has an oval-shaped hole that is meant to hold the neck of the top of the stand but there was no fastening mechanism.

Performance

Despite the Akai having the best contrast ratio as per our Spyder 3 Elite, the cheapest TV here, the Onida LCO32MMS was the most impressive in the movie tests. This was because the Akai LED32D20 had a problem with overbearing greens, and this couldn't be adjusted in the TV menu, meaning the colour green dominated every single image. In Avatar, where there was jungle and foliage with dappled sunlight, the sunlight had a greenish tinge to it as well.

Among the Onida TVs, the costlier LEO32HMS performed the worst. For starters, text wasn't sharp, and we had some image scaling issues. Movies lacked colour depth, and backlight response time was mediocre. The Onida LCO32MMS looked quite good, with good colour, and a really nice contrast. Where this display lost out was in DVD scaling, where

HOW WE TESTED

We divided the HDTVs into categories based on size. To test them, we used a test notebook with a GeForce GT555 graphics card and an HDMI out via a good quality HDMI 1.4a cable with noise filters. Additionally, we hooked up each HDTV to an LG BD550 Blu-Ray player via the same HDMI cable.

To gauge menus and such we played around with the settings. After this we calibrated each display using the Spyder 3 Elite. Before calibration settings were set to 50 per cent values, i.e. brightness, contrast, backlight and such were set to 50 per cent. There has been internal debate about which settings to use, whether a median value of 50 per cent or a value at which each display gives its best performance. Finally, in order to avoid subjectivity that arises from different reviewers, we chose the former method. All extra settings such as noise reduction, motion-related processing, dynamic contrast etc., were disabled. Post calibration we recorded brightness values, contrast values then ran our tests.

The 1080p test consisted of 3 files – Blu-Ray disc of *Avatar*, 1080p .MKV file of *Avatar*, and a 1080p .MKV file of *Robin Hood*. The 720p video test consisted of 3 files and we didn't use a Blu-Ray player for this. The movies used were *Clash Of The Titans*, *The Fast And The Furious*, *Ironman 2*. Finally our DVD movie was a .VOB file and we used *The Bank Job*.

We rated the TVs on their ability to display native 1080p content, as well as work with lower resolution content i.e. upscale. Particularly the DVD movie gives us an idea how the display will perform with really low resolution content. We judged the videos on the basis of overall image quality that is a function of colour purity, contrast, per pixel detail, absence of noise, and of course upscaling performance. For text sharpness we looked at icons on the Windows desktop as well as a .doc file. We also checked the USB functionality with both a flash drive and external HDD. We played back .DivX files encoded from .VOB, and MP4 files encoded from the .MKV format at 720p.

artifacts were noticeable in fast moving scenes, hair, as well as dim colours.

Winners

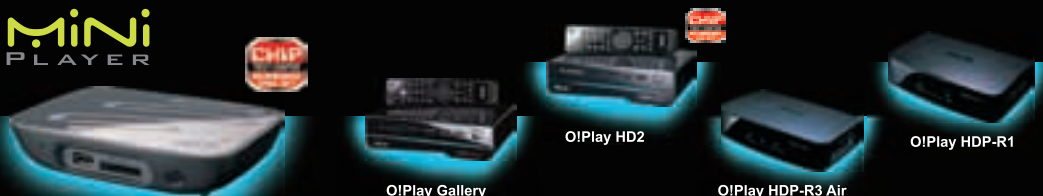
The Onida LCO32MMS walks home with our *Digit Best Buy* award thanks to its excellent mix of price and performance. Its rare to see the cheapest

anything also perform the best in a group, and if you're looking for a great 32-inch TV, this is one that we can certify. The Onida LCD32DRT also makes a decent buy but it's slightly costlier than a model that is no worse of in any of the tests, save for sound performance.

Mini in Size-Massive on Entertainment

O!PLAY Mini
HD MEDIA PLAYER

- The Most Powerful 1080p Decoder
- Impressive TrueHD 7.1 Channel Audio Enjoyment
- Easy Access 4-in-1 Multi Card Reader



ASUS - No.1 in Quality and Services - The Wall Street Journal Asia

www.asus.in | Toll Free No. 1800-2090-365

For Feedback Email reachus@asus.com | Log on to www.asusservice.com

ASUS
Inspiring Innovation • Persistent Perfection